

Worksheet

Rohan Alexander

25 September, 2026

Draft from results

Below are three sets of results. For each, write a title, a one-paragraph abstract, and a results paragraph, following the structure from the lecture: the abstract says what was done, what was found, and why it matters, in that order; the results paragraph states the finding, points to the table, and says what the numbers mean, without repeating the table in prose. Then pick one and write its introduction (four paragraphs: the broad context, the specific gap, what this paper does, what it finds).

Result set A: Toronto shelter occupancy

Average number of people in Toronto's shelter system each night, by sector, from the City of Toronto's daily shelter overnight occupancy data (Open Data Toronto, 2026).

Sector	January 2026	August 2026
Families	2,295	2,027
Men	2,058	1,578
Mixed Adult	3,042	2,443
Women	1,081	887
Youth	741	705
All sectors	9,217	7,640

Result set B: Iris measurements

Means (standard deviations) of four measurements, in centimetres, for 50 flowers of each of three iris species (collected by Edgar Anderson, and used by Fisher (1936)).

Species	Sepal length	Sepal width	Petal length	Petal width
Setosa	5.01 (0.35)	3.43 (0.38)	1.46 (0.17)	0.25 (0.11)
Versicolor	5.94 (0.52)	2.77 (0.31)	4.26 (0.47)	1.33 (0.20)
Virginica	6.59 (0.64)	2.97 (0.32)	5.55 (0.55)	2.03 (0.27)

Result set C: A simulation

Samples of increasing size were drawn from a standard normal distribution (mean 0, standard deviation 1) with seed 853, and the absolute difference between the sample mean and the population mean recorded (the `hello.py` script from Week 1).

Sample size	Absolute difference
10	0.230
100	0.157
1,000	0.027
10,000	0.006

Edit three drafts

Each paragraph below is a draft results or discussion paragraph about the shelter data. Edit each one so that it says what it has to say in the fewest words that are still clear, in the active voice, with the finding first. Zinsser on clutter, King on adverbs, and Mensh and Kording on one paragraph making one point are the tools. Cross out and rewrite on the page.

Draft 1

It is important to note that, as can be clearly seen from the results that are presented in Table 1 above, there was found to be a very significant decrease in the total number of individuals who were making use of the shelter system in the City of Toronto over the course of the period of time between the month of January and the month of August in the year 2026, with the total falling quite dramatically from a figure of approximately 9,217 people to a figure of approximately 7,640 people.

Draft 2

The data were downloaded and the columns were selected and the rows with missing values were filtered out and then the data were aggregated by date and sector and it was found that the decline was seen in every sector but it was largest for men and it was smallest for youth and the reasons for this are not known but they could be related to policy changes or seasonal factors or data quality or other things which would need to be investigated in future work.

Draft 3

Utilizing a comprehensive polars-based ETL pipeline leveraging the CKAN API endpoint, we operationalized nightly occupancy as `SERVICE_USER_COUNT` aggregated at the sector-date grain. Our findings robustly demonstrate a monotonic downward trajectory across the temporal window, notwithstanding the heterogeneity of bed-based versus room-based capacity modalities, which represents a paradigm-relevant contribution to the shelter utilization literature.

Referee a paper

You have been given a paper, written entirely by a language model in response to the Donaldson paper prompt. Write a one-paragraph referee report answering one question: is it any good, and how do you know? Name at least one specific thing you checked (a number, a figure, a claim about the data, a citation) and say what you found when you checked it. Hand this in; it will be used again in Week 10.

Your Donaldson paper

Write down the dataset you will use, the question you will answer with it, the one graph you expect to be the centre of the paper, and the thing you are most worried about. We will go through these.

References

Fisher, Ronald. 1936. "The Use of Multiple Measurements in Taxonomic Problems." *Annals of Eugenics* 7 (2): 179–88. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1469-1809.1936.tb02137.x>.